Installing & Configuring Git

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You can install through the **package management tool** that comes with your distribution.

Installing git on Ubuntu

sudo apt install git-all

You may also install from source by following steps defined here

Configurations

Git Config Tool

Git comes with a tool called ***git config*** that lets you **get** and **set** configuration variables that control all aspects of how Git looks and operates.

a. ***/etc/gitconfig*** file: Contains values applied to **every user** on the system and **all** their **repositories**.

git config --system option, means to read and write from this file specifically.

a. ***~/.gitconfig*** or ***~/.config/gitconfig*** file values specific **personally** to you, the user.

   git config --global option, means to read and write from this file specifically and this affects all of the repositories you work with on your system

b. ***config*** file in the **Git directory** (that is, **.git/config**) of whatever repository you're currently using: **Specific** to that **single repository**.

   git config --local option, means to read and write from this file specifically and this is by default

1. Setting your identity : this is **important** because every **Git commit uses** this information

   # set your user name and email address

   git config --global user.name "sajid ali"

   git config --global user.email "sajid.ali@giki.edu.pk"

2. Set your Editor

set your default editor

git config --global core.editor emacs

#On windows you have to set full path of the executable file of the editor

git config --global core.editor "C:\ProgramData\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs \Notepad++.exe"

3. Default Branch Name: By default Git will create a **branch** called **master** when you create a **new repository** with **git init**. From Git version 2.28 onwards, you can **set** a **different name** for the **initial branch**.

   # set your initial branch

   git config --global init.defaultBranch main

Checking Settings

#Use following command to list all the configuration details

git config --list --show-origin

#You may also use keyname to list its value

git config user.name

Getting Help

Three equivalent ways to get the comprehensive manual page (manpage) help for any of the Git commands

git help <verb>

git <verb> --help

man git-<verb>